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STORE SEO

9 ROBOTS.TXT MISTAKES THAT HURT ONLINE STORES

Shopify + WooCommerce edition. Swipe →

robots.txt

```
1 User-agent: *
2 Disallow: /wp-content/
3 Disallow: /
4 Disallow: /Products/
5 Allow: /products/
6 Sitemap: https://yourstore.com/sitemap.xml
```

Shopify **WooCommerce**

SWIPE →



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FIRST: WHAT ROBOTS.TXT DOES

It controls **crawling, not indexing.** A blocked URL can still appear in Google if it's linked.

ROBOTS.TXT

Disallow: /old-sale/

→

GOOGLEBOT

Can't crawl ✕

Can't read the page

→

GOOGLE SEARCH

Can still be indexed

if other pages link to it

SEARCH CONSOLE STATUS

“Indexed, though blocked by robots.txt”

CRAWLING

robots.txt

INDEXING

noindex tag



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MISTAKE 1: BLOCKING CSS OR JS

Google needs them to render your product pages. **Never disallow /wp-content/ or theme assets.**

robots.txt

```
1 User-agent: *
2 Disallow: /wp-content/
3 Disallow: /assets/
```

WHAT GOOGLE SEES

No styles · no scripts

WHAT SHOPPERS SEE

Add to cart



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MISTAKE 2: BLOCKING A PAGE YOU WANT REMOVED

If Google can't crawl it, it can't see your noindex tag. **Allow crawl + noindex, or remove the page.**

✕ BLOCKED + NOINDEX

robots.txt

```
1 Disallow: /old-page/
```

```
<meta name="robots"
content="noindex">
```

Google never sees the tag

✔ CRAWL + NOINDEX

robots.txt

```
1 # no rule for /old-page/
```

```
<meta name="robots"
content="noindex">
```

Google reads it and drops the page

Or remove the page: **404/410** or **301** to the closest match.



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MISTAKE 3: LEAVING “DISALLOW: /” AFTER LAUNCH

Staging rules shipped to live. **Check this file on every launch or migration.**

STAGING

staging.yourstore.com/robots.t

```
1 User-agent: *
2 Disallow: /
```

Correct here

× LIVE STORE

yourstore.com/robots.txt

```
1 User-agent: *
2 Disallow: /
```

Blocks the whole store

Check robots.txt on every launch and migration



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MISTAKE 4: DELETING SHOPIFY'S DEFAULT RULES

robots.txt.liquid lets you edit. Keep the defaults for /cart, /checkout, /search and sort URLs. **Add, don't replace.**

templates/robots.txt.liquid

```
{% for group in robots.default_groups %}
  {{- group.user_agent }}
  {%- for rule in group.rules -%}
    {{ rule }}
  {%- endfor -%}
  {%- if group.user_agent.value == '*' -%}
    {{ 'Disallow: /*?q=*' }}
  {%- endif -%}
{%- endfor %}
```

KEEP THE DEFAULTS `/cart` `/checkout` `/search` `sort URLs`

Add, don't replace. Put your custom lines inside the default loop.



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MISTAKE 5: NOT HANDLING FILTER PARAMETERS

WooCommerce ?filter_ and ?orderby= URLs can multiply. **Decide which to block based on scale.**

```
/shop/?filter_color=red
/shop/?filter_color=red&filter_size=m
/shop/?filter_color=red&orderby=price
/shop/?orderby=popularity&filter_size=m
```

+ thousands more combinations

robots.txt (example)

```
# Decide based on scale
Disallow: /*?filter_
Disallow: /*orderby=
```

Small store: often fine to leave. **Large catalogue:** block the combinations Google wastes time on.



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MISTAKE 6 + 7: WILDCARD TYPOS AND CASE ERRORS

Paths are case-sensitive. One wrong * can block your whole /products/ folder. **Test before saving.**

```
Disallow: /Products/
```

Doesn't match **/products/** (case-sensitive)

```
Disallow: /*products
```

Blocks **every** URL containing “products”

```
Disallow: /products/*?variant=
```

Only the URLs you meant

Test before saving



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MISTAKE 8 + 9: NO SITEMAP LINE, NEVER TESTING

Add **Sitemap: https://yourstore.com/sitemap.xml**. Check GSC's robots.txt report after every change.

robots.txt

```
1 User-agent: *
2 Disallow: /cart
3 Sitemap: https://yourstore.com/sitemap.xml
```

SEARCH CONSOLE · SETTINGS · ROBOTS.TXT REPORT

https://yourstore.com/robots.txt	Fetched
Last checked	[date]
Issues	[X]

Mock screen · placeholder data



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FREE TEMPLATES

COMMENT

"ROBOTSTXT"

Get **annotated Shopify + WooCommerce robots.txt files.**

S

Shopify

`robots.txt.liquid`

Annotated template

W

WooCommerce

`robots.txt`

Annotated template

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